

ACADEMIC ESSAY RUBRIC

	TASK ACHIEVEMENT	ORGANIZATION	GRAMMAR	VOCABULARY
5	- provides a full response to all parts of the prompt all main ideas are relevant, though there may be rare irrelevant or incorrect information while extending ideas - all ideas are fully developed	- a very well-organized text; main ideas and supporting ideas are presented in a logical order - ideas can be followed with almost no rereading of the text - a wide range of discourse markers used with almost complete accuracy and appropriacy - each paragraph has a central main idea - transitions between paragraphs are signaled	- a wide range of structures used with almost complete accuracy and appropriacy - errors are rare and do not impede understanding almost all of the structures used adheres to academic writing conventions (e.g. formal, impersonal; avoids contractions, personal pronouns, direct questions, and addressing the reader) - punctuation used correctly throughout	- a wide range of vocabulary used with almost complete accuracy and appropriacy - errors are rare and do not impede understanding almost all of the vocabulary used adheres to academic writing conventions (e.g. formal, impersonal) - almost no spelling mistakes
4	- answers all parts of the prompt to a good extent most of the main ideas are relevant and developed to a good extent, though there may be occasional irrelevant or incorrect information while extending ideas	- a mostly well-organized text; main ideas and supporting ideas are mostly presented in a logical order - ideas can be followed without much rereading of the text - a good range of discourse markers used accurately and appropriately, though there may be some under/over-use - each paragraph has a central main idea	- a good range of structures used with almost complete accuracy and appropriacy - errors are occasional and do not impede understanding most of the structures used adheres to academic writing conventions; any informal use does not reduce communicative effect - punctuation used mostly correctly	- a good range of vocabulary used with almost complete accuracy and appropriacy - errors are occasional and do not impede understanding most of the vocabulary used adheres to academic writing conventions; any informal use does not reduce communicative effect occasional spelling mistakes
3	- answers all parts of the prompt, but there may be a slight lack of balance in the development of ideas - a couple of main ideas may need further development OR a couple of the supporting ideas may include irrelevant and/or incorrect information	- an adequately organized text; main ideas and supporting ideas may not be presented completely logically - ideas can be followed fairly easily with some rereading of the text - an adequate range of discourse markers that are generally used accurately - paragraphs are present, but each paragraph may not have a single main idea	- an adequate range of structures that are generally used accurately and appropriately - errors sometimes impede understanding, but the overall message is clear - attempts to use formal structures, but there might be a slight imbalance between formal and informal structures - punctuation used generally correctly	- an adequate range of vocabulary generally used accurately and appropriately - errors sometimes impede understanding, but the overall message is clear - attempts to use formal vocabulary, but there might be a slight imbalance between formal and informal vocabulary some spelling mistakes
2	- answers only some parts of the prompt, OR answers all parts of the prompt, but ideas are clearly underdeveloped some main and/or supporting ideas may include noticeable irrelevant and/or incorrect information	- an inadequately organized text; some ideas are presented; but there is limited logical organization (i.e. ideas may be relevant but just thrown into the paragraph) - an inadequate range of discourse markers that are generally used accurately OR a range of discourse markers that are generally used inaccurately - paragraphs may be present, but lack main ideas	- an inadequate range of structures with some basic language errors - errors are frequent and may impede understanding - attempts to use formal structures, but there are frequent instances of language use that do not adhere to academic writing conventions frequent mistakes in punctuation	- an inadequate range of vocabulary used accurately, OR a range of vocabulary used inaccurately - errors are frequent and may impede understanding - attempts to use formal vocabulary, but there are frequent instances of vocabulary use that do not adhere to academic writing conventions frequent mistakes in spelling
1	minimal attempt to answer the prompt - includes part of an irrelevant response limited sample to assess	- a poorly organized text - a limited range of discourse markers used inaccurately and/or repetitively - there may be no sign of paragraphing OR may lack introduction, body paragraphs and/or conclusion	- a poor range of structures with basic and systematic language errors - errors frequently impede understanding minimal attempt to use formal structures - punctuation mistakes throughout	- a poor range of vocabulary used inaccurately and inappropriately - errors frequently impede understanding minimal attempt to use formal vocabulary - spelling mistakes throughout
0	no attempt to answer the prompt/ totally irrelevant response / absent			